REPORT

OF THE PORTFOLIO COMMITTEE ON DEFENCE, HOME AFFAIRS, SECURITY SERVICES AND WAR VETERANS' AFFAIRS

ON

THE IMPACT OF PROJECTS BEING IMPLEMENTED BY THE LOTTERIES AND GAMING BOARD AS PART OF ITS CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY IN ZIMBABWE.

SECOND SESSION – TENTH PARLIAMENT

Presented to Parliament February 2026

S.C.59, 2025

ORDERED IN TERMS OF STANDING ORDER No. 18:

i. At the commencement of every session, there shall be as many committees to be designated according to government portfolios as the Standing Rules and Orders Committee may deem fit.

ii. It shall be the function of such committees to examine expenditure administration and policy of government departments and other matters falling under their jurisdictions as Parliament may, by resolution determine.

iii. The Members of such committees shall be appointed by the Standing Rules and Orders Committee, from one or both Houses of Parliament, and such appointments shall take into account the expressed interests or expertise of the Members and Senators and the political and gender composition of Parliament.

iv. Each select Committee shall be known by the portfolio determined for it by the Standing Rules and Orders Committee.

TERMS OF REFERENCE OF PORTFOLIO COMMITTEES S.O 21

Subject to these Standing Orders a Portfolio Committee shall:

i. Examine expenditure administration and policy of government departments and other matters falling under their jurisdictions as Parliament may, by resolution determine;

ii. Consider and deal with all Bills and Statutory Instruments or other matters which are referred to it by or under a resolution of the House or by the Speaker;

iii. Consider or deal with an appropriation or money bill or any aspect of appropriation or money bill referred to it by these Standing Orders or by or under resolution of this House;

iv. Monitor, investigate, inquire into and make recommendations relating to any aspect of the legislative programme, budget, rationalisation, policy formulation or any other matter it may consider relevant of the government department falling within the category of affairs assigned to it, and may for that purpose consult and liaise with such a department;

v. Consider or deal with all international treaties, conventions and agreements relevant to it, which are from time to time negotiated, entered into or agreed upon.

SPEAKER OF PARLIAMENT ANNOUNCEMENT

On Tuesday 8 October 2024, Mr. Speaker announced that Committees should continue to operate as previously constituted until such time that new Committees are appointed by the Committee on Standing Rules and Orders.

The Committee consists of the following:
Hon. Maoneke E (Chairperson)

Hon. Sithole S,

Hon. Chibhagu G,

Hon. Chikwinya N,

Hon. Makumbe T,

Hon. Mashavave G,

Hon. Butawu Z,

Hon. Mutimbanyoka K,

Hon. Mashonganyika D,

Hon. Kaitano K,

Hon. Pindukai T,

Hon. Chimbaira G,

Hon Mukuhlani T

Hon. Mahlangu S,

Hon. Madzivanyika C,

Hon. Nyamuronda R,

Hon Gumbo A,

Hon Ncube E,

Hon Musanhi K,

Hon Murwira T,

Hon Khupe T

Hon Mhetu Z,

Hon Mudzingwa L,

Hon Mavhudzi M,

Hon Ncuve F,

Hon Sakupwanya S,

Hon Mpofu R

1.0 INTRODUCTION

In the pursuit of Zimbabwe's Vision 2030 agenda which seeks to transform the country into an upper-middle-income economy, the role of strategic institutions in catalyzing inclusive development cannot be overstated. Lotteries and Gaming Board (LGB) has emerged as a proactive and transformative agent, extending its mandate far beyond regulatory functions to become a catalyst for community empowerment and national development. Through a diverse of Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives, the LGB has positioned itself as a key partner in the realization of the National Development Strategy 1 (NDS1). Its interventions span vital sectors including education, health, heritage management, sports and recreation, infrastructure development and support for vulnerable or disadvantaged populations. These efforts are not only aligned with the pillars of NDS1 such as Human Capital Development, Social Protection, and Infrastructure Development but also resonate with the global Sustainable Development Goals and the national ethos of "leaving no one and no place behind."

From rehabilitating schools in marginalised areas to equipping health facilities, promoting youth development through sport, safeguarding national heritage, and responding to humanitarian crises, the LGB's interventions are far more than acts of charity. They represent strategic investments in the social fabric of the nation building. It is against this background that, the Committee on Defence, Home Affairs, Security Services and War Veterans Affairs resolved to conduct an enquiry into the impact of projects being implemented by the Lotteries and Gaming Board as part of its cooperate social responsibilities and establish the challenges they face in implementing these and proffer recommendations that could create opportunities for sustainable development

2.0 OBJECTIVES

The objectives of the oversight visit were:

1. To assess the impact of the corporate social responsibility initiatives being implemented by the Lotteries and Gaming Board on local communities in line with NDS 1;
2. To identify the challenges faced by the LGB in implementing and sustaining Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives and;
3. To proffer recommendations

3.0 METHODOLOGY

The Committee employed the following methods:

1. It received oral evidence from the Interim Secretary for Lotteries and Gaming Board on 19 May 2025;
2. It gathered evidence from project management representatives, local leaders and community representatives on the impact of projects implemented by the Lotteries and Gaming Board.
3. It analysed written submissions from the Lotteries and Gaming Board on projects being implemented in different communities which prompted the need for the Committee to assess their impact.
4. Conducted field visits to projects being implemented by the Lotteries and Gaming Board from 16 to 20 June 2025, as shown below

Table 1: Lotteries and Gaming Board projects visited by the Committee

DATE	PLACE	ACTIVITY
Monday 16 June 2025	Mutasa	Herbet Chitepo Skills Training center and Elim Primary School
Tuesday 17 June 2025	Gutu	Kamungoma Heritage Site
Wednesday 18 June 2025	Zaka	Harawa Mothers` Shelter
Thursday 19 June 2025	Lupane	Pupu Clinic, Pupu Heritage site Mabhigwa Secondary School
Friday 20 June 2025	Kadoma	Karigamome Secondary School

4.0 COMMITTEE FINDINGS

4.1 The mandate of the Lotteries and Gaming Board

Dr M. Chingozha, the Interim Secretary for the Lotteries and Gaming Board, informed the Committee that in line with section 53 (2) (i) to ((j) of the Lotteries and Gaming Act [Chapter 10:26], the Board provides support to socioeconomic activities in various sectors that include but not limited to health, education, sports and recreation, preservation of national heritage, monuments and environment, social service and support for Private Voluntary Organisations registered with the Ministry of Labour and Social welfare among others. He also added that, the Board is a self-funded corporate entity (State Enterprise) established under Section 3 of the Lotteries and Gaming Act [Chapter 10.26] to serve as the regulatory authority in overseeing the lotteries and gaming industry in Zimbabwe. In terms of revenue generation, the Board collects its revenue licenses and 2% of the gross gaming revenue levied on all bookmakers. From that amount, 1.8% of the revenue is then directed towards cooperate social responsibility initiatives.

The Secretary further highlighted that, in terms of selection of projects, the Board has a Corporate Social Responsibility Policy which details how projects are identified for support and selection is done through applications that are approved and considered by the Board in each budget year. When approving such applications, the Board considers whether the area is indeed disadvantaged, the urgency of the need, the population size and the impact of the projects if not or if implemented to the society. He also added that, when implementing such projects, the Board collaborates closely with local communities, including traditional leaders and relevant Government Ministries. Prior to launching any project, community members are encouraged to select representatives from among themselves to form a Local Project Committee, which serves as the implementing body, responsible for overseeing day-to-day execution of projects. The Board assist in providing funding for such projects and also proves strategic oversight.

4.2 Projects being implemented by the Lotteries and Gaming Board inn local in communities

4.2.1 Health promotion and development

Zimbabwe has experienced a notable decline in the availability and quality of health facilities and infrastructure, a situation that has become increasingly concerning in light of the country's rapidly growing population. Many existing clinics and hospitals, particularly in rural and peri-urban areas, are overstretched and under-resourced, struggling to meet the rising demand for essential health services. The mismatch between population growth and infrastructure development has led to overcrowded facilities, long waiting times, and limited access to specialized care. In response to this crisis, the Lotteries and Gaming Board has stepped in as a strategic partner in health sector revitalization. Through targeted interventions and funding allocations, the Board has supported the construction of health facilities, such as Harava clinic in Zaka and Pupu clinic in Lupane in order to enhance health sector service delivery in underserved areas.

During the visits to health facilities constructed by Lotteries and Gaming Board, the Committee noted that the organisation has transformed Zimbabwe's public health infrastructure, particularly in underserved rural communities. At Harava Clinic in Zaka District, Mrs T. Chivizhe, Sister in Charge at the clinic, informed the Committee that the intervention by the LGB in funding the construction of the 1x3 block for mothers waiting shelter and equipment to the clinic has provided a relief to a population of 9000 from 22 villages and other districts. The same sentiments were also echoed by the local Councilor who stated that the district has recorded a

significant drop in instances of home deliveries, maternal and neonatal morbidity and mortality rates in the district.

Apart from Harava Clinic, construction of Pupu Clinic in Lupane by LGB demonstrated its commitment to enhance infrastructure development in the health sector. While at the clinic, Mrs Ngwenya, the Senior Nurse in Charge, informed the Committee that the construction of the clinic had reduced travelling distances to the surrounding communities where people used to travel 80km to Lupane District hospital. The area has an approximate population of over 6000 people which largely rely on accessing services at the clinic. On average the clinic service up to 60 outpatients per day and approximately three births per week. She further added that the initiatives by LGB directly support the government's inclusive development agenda and align with the Zimbabwe Health Strategy 2021–2025, which prioritizes universal access to quality healthcare services. These efforts were also underpinned by the Public Health Act [Chapter 15:17] of 2018, which mandates the State to ensure accessible, adequate health services for all citizens and prohibits denial of emergency treatment. Through these legal frameworks, the LGB's clinic construction projects not only fulfil statutory obligations but also embody the constitutional right to health care, contributing meaningfully to national well-being and equity.

4.2.2 Education and skills training development

Zimbabwe is currently facing a critical shortage of schools, a challenge that has become increasingly pronounced in the face of rising demand for education across the country. Rapid population growth, coupled with expanding communities in both urban and rural areas, has placed immense pressure on the existing education infrastructure. Many schools are overcrowded, with limited classroom space, inadequate learning materials, and strained teacher-to-student ratios. In some remote regions, children are forced to walk long distances to access the nearest school, while others attend classes in makeshift structures that lack basic amenities.

In light of these pressing needs, the Lotteries and Gaming Board has stepped in as a key player in supporting the education sector. Through its targeted interventions, the Board has funded the construction of new classroom blocks at Elim Primary School in Penhalonga, refurbished dilapidated facilities at Herbet Chitepo in Mutasa, and provided essential learning resources to underserved communities. These efforts have helped to bridge the infrastructure gap, particularly in marginalized areas where government resources alone have been inadequate. By channeling proceeds from regulated gaming activities into educational development, the Board is not only

enhancing access to quality education but also contributing to the broader national goal of inclusive and equitable learning.

During the field visit at Herbert Chitepo, Mr. Shiridzinomwa, Vice Chairperson of the Local Organizing Committee at Herbert Chitepo, informed the Committee that prior to the intervention by the Lotteries and Gaming Board, the center could only accommodate 20 students per term. He stated that enrolment had since increased to 80 students per term following infrastructure improvements. According to him, the center had begun attracting students from across the country, particularly those seeking training in welding, joinery, and tourism and hospitality management. He also revealed that the Board was currently funding the construction of a new skills training block, which, upon completion, would have the capacity to host up to 250 students across various disciplines. The Committee, however was disappointed to note the that process for the construction of the skills training block was stalled since March due to delayed approval of additional budget amounting to USD 14 300 by the Board of directors which sits once in every quarter.

A similar trend was observed at Elim Primary School, where enrolment had previously declined from 200 to 90 students due to insufficient facilities. Mrs. Kuweyini, the School Head, expressed her appreciation for the Board's support, stating that, the construction of a modern 1x2 classroom block had significantly improved the school's learning environment. She noted that the intervention had enhanced academic focus and examination readiness among upper-grade learners with enrolment increasing from 90 to 320 students, and it has helped reduce the practice of hot sitting.

4.2.3 Sport infrastructure and development

The absence of modern, well-maintained sporting facilities has severely hindered the growth and competitiveness of Zimbabwe's sports sector. Over the years, the country's sporting infrastructure has deteriorated to such an extent that most venues no longer meet international standards. Stadiums, training grounds, and community sports centers across Zimbabwe suffer from chronic neglect, outdated equipment, and a lack of consistent maintenance. Many facilities are plagued by damaged seating, poor lighting, inadequate sanitation, and unsafe playing surfaces conditions that not only make them unsuitable for hosting competitive events but also stifle the development of local athletic talent. Recognizing this urgent need, the Lotteries and Gaming Board has stepped in as a key stakeholder in revitalizing Zimbabwe's sports infrastructure.

The LGB has played a pivotal role in advancing sports development in Zimbabwe through strategic investments in infrastructure. Notable examples of these facilities include multi-purpose sporting facilities at Hebert Chitepo in Mutasa, Karigamombe Secondary School in Kadoma and Mabikwa High School in Lupane. This initiative aligns with the objectives outlined in Zimbabwe's National Sports and Recreation Policy, which emphasizes the development of inclusive, accessible, and high-quality sporting infrastructure across the country. By investing in school-based facilities, the LGB contributes directly to the policy's goals of nurturing talent from grassroots levels, integrating sport into the education system, and creating pathways for athletes to compete at national and international levels.

During visit at Mabikwa High School, Mr S. Phiri, the Deputy School Head informed the Committee that the school had become the only institution in the province capable of hosting provincial competitions. The facility accommodates disciplines such as tennis, volleyball, and netball. She added that, since the construction of the facility the school has successfully produced 2 students who qualified to participate in international sporting events.

4.2.4 Preservation of cultural heritage

Zimbabwe has relatively few officially recognized cultural heritage sites, yet their importance to the nation is profound and multifaceted. These sites serve as tangible links to the country's rich history, traditions, identity and preserving the legacy of ancient civilizations such as Great Zimbabwe, the Kingdom of Mutapa, and the Ndebele State. Beyond their historical value, cultural heritage sites play a vital role in education, tourism, and economic development. They provide learning opportunities for students and researchers. Recognizing the significance of these sites, the LGB has emerged as a key partner in their preservation and promotion. Through strategic funding initiatives, the Board has supported the restoration of heritage landmarks, development of interpretive centers, and enhancement of infrastructure around cultural sites.

The Committee noted that funding for establishment of heritage sites by the Lotteries and Gaming Board in areas such as Pupu in Lupane and Kamungoma in Gutu reflect its broader vision of using heritage preservation as a tool for education, tourism, and community empowerment while reinforcing the values that define Zimbabwe's national character. During field visit to Kamungoma Heritage site in Gutu, Mr V. Mbanje, the caretaker told the Committee that since its establishment in 2024, a number of tourists were visiting the site, including learners

from different schools who were conducting educational tours to the field museum as part of enhancing studies in history and heritage studies. Similarly, at Pupu Monument in Lupane, Mr M. Khumalo, the Caretaker also echoed the sentiments Mr Mbanje by stating that the establishment of these heritage sites helped to ensure that pivotal moments and figures in the country's history are not forgotten. He also added that Pupu Heritage Site was established in honor King Lobengula's resistance against colonial invasion and many people were interested to visit the site where King Lobengula was last seen.

The Committee further noted that heritage sites and monuments are instrumental in instilling national memory, fostering reconciliation, and educating future generations about the cost of liberation struggle. Indeed, they are a cornerstone of national identity, serving to unite communities, preserve historical memory, and educate future generations about their origins and shared values. They connect the past to the present, instilling pride and a sense of belonging among citizens. Thus, support by LGB was motivated by a deep commitment to national development, social cohesion and the urgent need to protect and celebrate Zimbabwe's historical landmarks.

4.3 Challenges faced by the LGB in implementing and sustaining Corporate Social Responsibility initiatives

4.3.1 Lack of urgency by other stakeholders in attending to issues

The Committee expressed concern over lack of urgency by other stakeholders to address issues was undermining efforts by the Lotteries and Gaming Board in implementing their projects. This was evident during the visit to Harava Clinic in Zaka, where Mr. V. Shumba, the Board's Monitoring and Evaluation Officer, revealed to the Committee that, although the Board had donated building materials for the construction of staff houses at the clinic, progress was stalled due to delays in plan approval by the district engineer within the Ministry of Local Government and Public Works. As a result, construction could not commence as scheduled. The same sentiments were shared by Mrs T. Chivizhe, Sister in Charge at the clinic who expressed concern over the prolonged delays in approval of plans, noting the risk of cement expiring before use. Such setbacks undermine the impact of well-intentioned interventions and highlight the urgent need for coordinated efforts among all responsible agencies.

4.3.2 Maintenance of projects funded by Lotteries and Gaming Board

Despite the LGB`s commendable efforts in funding the construction of vital public infrastructure, responsible authorities often neglect and fail to maintain these facilities. During field visit to Pupu Clinic in Lupane, the Committee found a glaring lack of ownership and maintenance by the Lupane City Council, which has significantly compromised the clinic's operational effectiveness. Mrs. Ngwenya, the Senior Sister in Charge, reported that the clinic had been without electricity for over six months due to non-payment by Lupane City Council, a situation that gravely affects maternal care and other critical services. Additionally, the clinic had no running water owing to a blocked pipe, further compromising hygiene and safety of patients.

The Committee further expressed deep concern over the deteriorating structural conditions, including visible cracks on the clinic walls, with no remedial action taken by the Lupane City Council. Engineer Masuke from Lupane City Council admitted that since the clinic's commissioning in 2024, the Council was yet to develop a support roadmap, nor had it allocated a budget for the clinic's operational needs. This lack of planning and financial commitment reflects a broader challenge of poor institutional ownership, which risks rendering vital community infrastructure ineffective despite significant initial investment. Without proactive stewardship from the local authority, such projects struggle to deliver sustainable impact.

4.3.3 Budgeting for Projects

The Committee noted that under budgeting for project by contractors pose a significant challenge to the timely and effective implementation of the same. This concern was raised during a field visit to the Hebert Chitepo Skills Training Center, where Mr. Shiridzinomwa, Vice Chairperson of the Local Organizing Committee, reported that construction of the skills training block had stalled after the initial budget quoted by the contractor was exhausted at the roofing stage. The contractor, who had originally quoted USD 19,000 for the full project, later discovered that the estimate was insufficient and requested for an additional USD 14,300 to complete the facility. However, such budgetary variations require formal justification and approval by the Board of Directors, which convenes only once after every 4 months. The Committee further noted that the Board's sitting schedule which is limited to once every four months has a direct and adverse impact on project progress, as management lacks the authority to make decisions on behalf of the Board. In light of this, the Committee proposed that the Board consider delegating certain powers to management, enabling them to respond promptly to time-sensitive matters and ensure the uninterrupted implementation of critical infrastructure projects.

5.0 COMMITTEE OBSERVATIONS

The Committee made the following observations:

5.1 Interventions by the Lotteries and Gaming Board have significantly improved service delivery in previously underserved communities. These initiatives have not only advanced the implementation of key national policy frameworks, particularly the National Development Strategy 1 (NDS1), but have also played a pivotal role in bridging critical infrastructure gaps, fostering social equity, and reinforcing citizens' constitutional entitlement to quality public services.

5.2 The LGB has effectively utilized part of the 2% levy collected from bookmakers to implement a range of high-impact projects that align with Zimbabwe's national development priorities. These initiatives reflect prudent resource management and a strong commitment to inclusive service delivery across critical sectors.

5.3 The approval process for housing plans by the Ministry of Local Government and Public Works was generally prolonged, resulting in missed project deadlines and delays in implementation.

5.4 The authorities benefiting from LGB infrastructural support fail to sustain and maintain infrastructure such as clinics and schools developed on their behalf by LGB, a situation which may risk such facilities of becoming non-functional, thereby undermining the very purpose of public infrastructure investment.

5.5 Significant discrepancies in project quotations by contractors raise accountability concerns and pose a serious challenge to the timely execution of scheduled projects.

5.6 The Board of Directors' sitting schedule which is limited to only one meeting within four months creates a bottleneck in decision-making, particularly in cases requiring urgent financial adjustments. Management lacks the delegated authority to approve variations, resulting in project delays and increased costs.

6.0 RECOMMENDATIONS

The Committee made the following recommendations:

6.1 By 31 July 2026, the Ministry of Home Affairs and Cultural Heritage, through the LGB, whenever they receive requests from communities for funding, they should always ensure equitable distribution of projects across all the country's provinces and extend them to district level by collaborating with Traditional Leaders, Local Councils and Members of Parliament to foster community ownership and long-term sustainability.

6.2 By 30 June 2026, the Lotteries and Gaming Board should raise the levy on licensed Bookmakers from 2% to at least 4% to strengthen its resource base and expand the reach and impact of development projects benefiting marginalized communities

6.3 By 31 July 2026, the Ministry of Local Government and Public Works should expedite its plan approval process for the construction of public buildings, ensuring that all submitted applications are reviewed and approved within a maximum period of one month.

6.4 By 30 April 2026, Government Ministries should safeguard public investments by ensuring that, upon completion and handover of Lotteries and Gaming Board-funded projects, responsible authorities assume full ownership and commit to ongoing maintenance to preserve infrastructure value and sustain community service delivery.

6.5 By 31 March 2026, the Lotteries and Gaming Board should assess and verify contractors' capacity before awarding contracts to mitigate underquoting risks and ensure integrity and efficiency in project execution.

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7.0 CONCLUSION

The Committee acknowledges the commendable efforts of the Lotteries and Gaming Board (LGB) in advancing national development through strategic investments in education, healthcare, sports, and cultural preservation. These initiatives clearly align with the aspirations of the National Development Strategy 1 (NDS1) and demonstrate the Board's commitment to inclusive growth and social upliftment while the Lotteries and Gaming Board has laid a strong foundation for community transformation, sustained success will depend on robust governance, strategic partnerships, and a renewed focus on efficiency. The Committee remains grateful to the efforts being made by the Board in spearheading economic development.